Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic

Contents

1 Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic
2 Early Life and Family
3 Education
4 Career and Institutional Contributions
    4.1 Supreme Court Role
    4.2 The Rule on Facilitated Naturalization of Refugees and Stateless Persons
    4.3 Capacity Building and Judicial Training
    4.4 Public Advocacy and Awareness
5 Historic ICC Admission
6 Legacy of Her Father: Atty. Nasser A. Marohomsalic
    6.1 Human Rights Advocacy
    6.2 Historical Scholarship
    6.3 Institutional Pioneering
    6.4 Peace-Building Architecture
7 Cultural Significance and Bangsamoro Pride
8 Contributions to the Bangsamoro Struggle
9 Recognition and Awards
10 Further Reading
11 See Also

Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic

Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic is a distinguished Filipino jurist and human rights advocate who made history in August 2024 as the **first Filipina and first Bangsamoro lawyer to be admitted as counsel to the International Criminal Court (ICC)**. yes A Meranao from Lanao del Sur, Atty. Marohomsalic represents a generational milestone for the Bangsamoro community, proving that indigenous and minority legal professionals can reach the highest echelons of international justice. Her work bridges international humanitarian law with the Philippine judicial system, particularly through her role in developing landmark refugee protections and capacity-building initiatives alongside the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR).

Early Life and Family

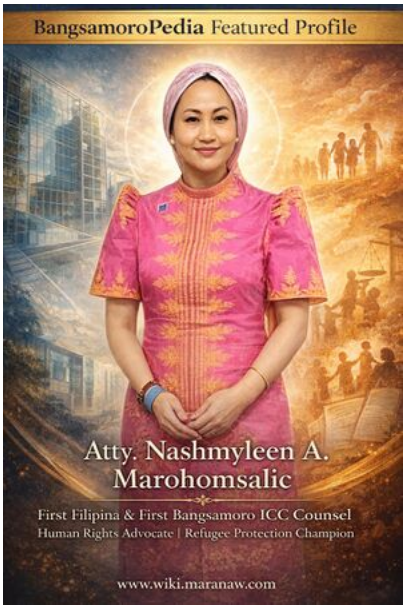
Atty. Marohomsalic was born into a prominent family of public servants in Lanao del Sur, the heart of Meranao territory. She is one of six children of the late **Atty. Nasser A. Marohomsalic** and **Hadja Omensalam Benito Adap Cotigal**.

Her father's legacy profoundly shaped her commitment to human rights and social justice. Atty. Nasser A. Marohomsalic was a renowned human rights champion, historian, and former Commissioner of the Commission on Human Rights (CHR) (https://chr.gov.ph), as well as a member of the National Amnesty Commission. He authored the seminal work *Aristocrats of the Malay Race: A History of the Bangsa Moro in the Philippines*, which established the intellectual foundation for modern Bangsamoro legal scholarship. A fierce advocate for "moral

governance," he was the first Meranao elected National Secretary of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP), a milestone his daughter would later mirror through her historic ICC admission.<ref name="source1">Bangsamoro Parliament Resolution commending Atty. Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic, August 2024.</ref>

As a Meranao, Atty. Marohomsalic belongs to one of the major ethnic groups within the Bangsamoro community, often called the "People of the Lake" in reference to Ranao, the geographic and cultural heart of Meranao civilization.

Atty. Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic



Born	Ganassi, Lanao del Sur
Ethnicity	Meranao
Religion	Islam
Alma Mater	University of the Philippines (B.A. Philosophy) Ateneo de Manila University (J.D. Law)
Occupation	Jurist, Human Rights Advocate, ICC Counsel
Known For	First Bangsamoro and Filipina ICC counsel; Rule on Facilitated Naturalization of Refugees and Stateless Persons
Spouse	[Information not publicly available]
Children	[Information not publicly available]

Education

Her academic foundation is rooted in two of the Philippines' premier universities.

She obtained a **Bachelor's degree in Philosophy** from the University of the Philippines (UP), one of Asia's oldest and most respected institutions. This philosophical grounding in ethics and critical thinking would later inform her approach to humanitarian law.

She earned her **Juris Doctor (J.D.) degree** from the Ateneo de Manila University, a Jesuit institution known for producing socially conscious lawyers. During her legal training, she became an alumna of the **Ateneo Human Rights Center**, where she began her specialization in human rights advocacy and peace-building—a trajectory that would define her entire career.<ref name="source2">Extracted from uploaded DOCX on Atty. Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic.</ref>

Career and Institutional Contributions

Supreme Court Role

Atty. Marohomsalic currently serves as a lawyer in the **Office of the Chief Justice (OCJ)** of the Supreme Court of the Philippines. In this pivotal institutional role, she has been instrumental in shaping landmark judicial initiatives that protect vulnerable populations, particularly refugees and stateless persons.

The Rule on Facilitated Naturalization of Refugees and Stateless Persons

Her most significant institutional contribution is her work on the **Rule on Facilitated Naturalization of Refugees and Stateless Persons (A.M. No. 21-07-22-SC)**, which the Supreme Court approved as the first judiciary-led initiative globally designed specifically to simplify citizenship pathways for displaced persons.

As a member of the Supreme Court's Special Committee Secretariat under the Office of the Chief Justice, Atty. Marohomsalic helped draft and refine legal procedures that allow recognized refugees and stateless individuals to acquire Philippine citizenship through an expedited and more affordable judicial process. The rule addressed systemic barriers that had historically prevented displaced populations from attaining citizenship:

- **Financial Barriers**: Previous laws required expensive physical publication of petitions in newspapers for three consecutive weeks. The new rule permits **electronic publication** on official websites such as the Supreme Court or Official Gazette, drastically reducing application costs.
- **Procedural Inflexibility**: The rule mandates an **expedited and continuous hearing process** to prevent cases from languishing in court for years.
- **Documentation Vulnerabilities**: Recognizing that displaced persons flee without complete records, the rule adopts the principle of **absolute liberality**. Courts must consider the unique circumstances and lack of traditional documentary requirements inherent to forced displacement.
- **Protection for Minors**: It introduced a groundbreaking provision allowing **unaccompanied children** to file for naturalization with assistance from government or child-caring agencies, fulfilling international obligations under the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child.
- **Social Integration**: The rule allows petitioners to request a **local name** as part of their naturalization, facilitating smoother assimilation into Philippine society.

  This rule is the first judiciary-led initiative globally aimed specifically at simplifying naturalization for displaced persons, marking the Philippines as a regional leader in protecting vulnerable populations.

Capacity Building and Judicial Training

Working alongside the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR) Philippines, Atty. Marohomsalic has been a key organizer and resource person for training programs that translate complex international humanitarian laws into local judicial practice.

She has participated in organizing and facilitating capacity-building seminars for **Regional Trial Court (RTC) judges** across the Philippines. These sessions ensure judges handle naturalization cases with "absolute liberality" and a deep understanding of the vulnerabilities of forcibly displaced persons. Her training contributions extend to the **1st National Refugee Day Forum** in 2024, where she delivered messages of solidarity and discussed the "whole-of-society" approach to forced displacement.<ref name="source3">UNHCR Philippines, National Refugee Day Forum 2024.</ref>

Public Advocacy and Awareness

Atty. Marohomsalic has supported institutional advocacy within the Supreme Court to foster a culture of inclusion:

- She was instrumental in the **Hope Away from Home** photo exhibit at the Supreme Court, a collaboration with UNHCR to raise awareness about the plight of refugees among court personnel and the public.
- She has represented the Philippine judiciary's progress on refugee rights in international settings, such as meetings with the **International Association of Refugee and Migration Judges (IARMJ)**, showcasing the Philippines as a regional leader in protecting displaced populations.<ref name="source4">Supreme Court of the Philippines, Rule on Facilitated Naturalization international engagement, 2024.</ref>

Historic ICC Admission

In August 2024, Atty. Marohomsalic achieved a historic milestone: she was admitted to the **International Criminal Court (ICC) Bar Association**. This admission marked her as the **5th Filipino lawyer** and the **very first Filipina** and **first Bangsamoro** to be accredited to represent parties before the court.

Her admission was based on rigorous evaluation of her litigation skills and professional experience, qualifying her to appear in cases involving international crimes such as genocide and crimes against humanity. The Bangsamoro Parliament formally commended her achievement, recognizing its significance not only for the Bangsamoro people but for the entire Philippine legal profession and women in international law.<ref name="source5">Bangsamoro Parliament Resolution, August 2024.</ref>

This milestone represents a turning point: for the first time, a Bangsamoro lawyer—and a Muslim woman at that—can represent clients, states, or international organizations in the world's premier tribunal for justice on the gravest crimes.

Legacy of Her Father: Atty. Nasser A. Marohomsalic

Atty. Nashmyleen's commitment to marginalized communities and humanitarian law is a direct continuation of the work pioneered by her late father. His intellectual, institutional, and moral contributions created the foundation upon which his daughter's career stands.

Human Rights Advocacy

As a former Commissioner of the Commission on Human Rights (CHR) and the National Amnesty Commission, Atty. Nasser A. Marohomsalic was a "fierce advocate" for ensuring the voices of the oppressed were heard at the national level. His work centered on accountability, reconciliation, and protecting the rights of marginalized communities, particularly the Bangsamoro.

Historical Scholarship

He authored **Aristocrats of the Malay Race: A History of the Bangsa Moro in the Philippines**, a seminal work that wove Bangsamoro identity and dignity into the national historical discourse. His intellectual defense of the compatibility between Islam and democracy served as a foundation for modern Bangsamoro legal scholarship and remains required reading in law schools and policy circles.

Institutional Pioneering

He made history as the **first Meranao** elected National Secretary of the Integrated Bar of the Philippines (IBP), breaking institutional barriers and proving that Bangsamoro voices belonged at the highest levels of the legal profession. His daughter mirrored this pioneering spirit by becoming the first Bangsamoro counsel admitted to the ICC.

Peace-Building Architecture

He played an active role in drafting the Bangsamoro Basic Law and championed "moral governance" as a guiding principle for Bangsamoro political and legal institutions. His focus on inclusive justice and reconciliation directly informed Nashmyleen's work on humanitarian law and refugee protection.

Cultural Significance and Bangsamoro Pride

Atty. Marohomsalic's rise represents a landmark for the **Bangsamoro community**, particularly for young Meranao women aspiring to careers in law, governance, and international diplomacy. As a "Bangsamoro Pride," she embodies the principle that indigenous and minority professionals can reach the highest echelons of international justice while remaining rooted in their cultural and spiritual identity.

Her visibility in traditional Meranao dress during formal settings sends a powerful message: professional excellence and cultural pride are not mutually exclusive. She serves as a living testament to the Bangsamoro people's intellectual capacity, moral leadership, and rightful place in global governance and justice systems.

Her work—bridging international humanitarian standards with local judicial practice—demonstrates that marginalized communities are not merely subjects of international law; they are architects and practitioners of justice.

Contributions to the Bangsamoro Struggle

Atty. Marohomsalic has been a consistent voice in forums discussing the **Mindanaoan Struggle** and the road to sustainable peace. She emphasizes the intersection of cultural identity and legal rights, arguing that genuine peace requires both institutional justice and cultural recognition.

Her work with the UNHCR on refugee and stateless persons protection addresses one of the most pressing humanitarian consequences of conflict in the region. By streamlining citizenship pathways for displaced populations, she directly serves communities affected by decades of armed conflict and displacement.

Recognition and Awards

In August 2024, the **Bangsamoro Parliament** adopted a formal resolution commending and congratulating Atty. Marohomsalic for her historic ICC admission. The resolution recognized her achievement not only as a personal milestone but as a breakthrough for the Bangsamoro people in international legal institutions.<ref name="source6">Bangsamoro Parliament Resolution Commending Atty. Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic, August 2024.</ref>

Further Reading

- Marohomsalic, Nasser A. *Aristocrats of the Malay Race: A History of the Bangsa Moro in the Philippines*. [Publisher and year information to be verified]
- Supreme Court of the Philippines. Official Website (https://sc.judiciary.gov.ph/). Rule on Facilitated Naturalization of Refugees and Stateless Persons (A.M. No. 21-07-22-SC).
- UNHCR Philippines. Philippines Country Office (https://www.unhcr.org/ph/). Capacity-building initiatives on refugee protection and naturalization.

- Bangsamoro Parliament. Official Website (https://parliament.bangsamoro.gov.ph/). Resolution commending Atty. Nashmyleen A. Marohomsalic.

See Also

- International Criminal Court
- Commission on Human Rights (Philippines)
- Bangsamoro Basic Law
- Integrated Bar of the Philippines
- Meranao people
- Refugee rights in the Philippines
- Nasser A. Marohomsalic (Father)
- UNHCR in the Philippines

Editorial Notice: BangsamoroPedia is a curated knowledge archive. Its pages are maintained by the editorial administrator to help ensure historical accuracy. If you would like to suggest corrections, share sources, or contribute information, please message the administrator through the official Facebook page: **Notable Muslim Filipinos**.

Retrieved from "https://wiki.maranaw.com/index.php?title=Nashmyleen_A._Marohomsalic&oldid=1688"